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ENGLISH LANGUAGE DEPARTMENT (ELD)

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ENGL101 STUDENT READING BOOK Part 1. V2

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Introduction to Active Reading

Important notes and benchmark dates to keep in mind:

Actively read texts 1-2 by the end of week 4. Read texts 3-4 by the end of week 7. One text in the Reading Midterm exam will be taken from texts 1-4.

*You will shortly be provided with a comprehensive guide as to what active reading entails and how you are supposed to practically implement active reading strategies. Please be sure to refer back to these guidelines throughout the semester in order to give yourself the best opportunity to achieve higher marks for your Reading Portfolio grade.

*Writing while you read and taking notes enables you to become an active reader and is an essential part of understanding a text.

What is Active Reading?

Active reading refers to the mental processes that highly effective readers use when approaching reading. It requires a reader to read critically by focusing on the material to understand and actively engage with the material by being aware of one's own thought process when reading. Through active reading readers gain greater critical thinking skills that makes things easier to understand and enables readers to retain information for a longer period.

What is Active Reading sourced and adapted from MPC reading skill sheets https://www.mpc.edu/academics/academic-divisions/humanities-division/programs-centers/reading-center/handouts.

Active Reading: General Strategies

Annotating

Marking and highlighting a text during reading is a way for readers to stay engaged with a reading and comprehend the reading at a deeper level. Readers record responses to the text during the act of reading and write ideas and personal comments in the margins.

Previewing

Readers look over the reading material to become familiar with topic and organization before actually beginning to read it. This helps make the reading an easier, faster, and more effective learning experience.

Skimming

The reader looks quickly through material to gain an overall view of text without reading everything.

Scanning

The readers look through a text to locate specific information without reading everything, such as names, dates, and figures/tables.

Reading on

Readers skip an unfamiliar word and read further to provide sufficient context needed to determine the meaning of an unknown word.

Re-Reading

A reader re-reads the text again for deeper understanding, word identification and fluency.

Monitoring Comprehension

Readers recognize when they don't understand parts of a text and take necessary steps to restore meaning. Monitoring includes asking clarifying questions if something remains unclear, re-reading if there is some confusion, looking for answers and adjust reading strategy to understand material.

Active Reading Strategies sourced and abridged from MPC reading skill sheets https://www.mpc.edu/academics/academicdivisions/humanities-division/programs-centers/reading-center/handouts.

Determining Importance

Readers distinguish between what information in a text is most important versus what information is interesting but not necessary for understanding. Knowing the primary purpose of reading textbooks and nonfiction is important to determine importance.

Author's Purpose

Being aware of the author's purpose allows a reader to understand the reason and intent of the writing.

Paraphrasing

Readers re-state and re-write text in their own words to capture the author's main idea and details of the reading. This strategy forces readers to pay close attention to the author's ideas and helps improve the readers' level of understanding.

Summarizing

Readers reduces larger texts to focus on important elements by identifying key elements and condensing important information into their own words to solidify meaning.

Questioning

Readers engage with the text by asking questions about the text and the author's intentions. They then seek information to clarify and extend their thinking before, during and after reading.

Synthesizing

Readers piece together and combine information from their own knowledge of how life works with the information they have gathered and understood from the text to create their own perspective and original insight.

Evaluating

The reader forms an opinion and judgment about the writing. They determine whether the argument (if there is one) is well or poorly structured, supported, or detailed; whether the writing style is appropriate, efficient, or well-toned--whether the audience is appropriately addressed; or if the author is biased in any way and how this may have affected the writing.

Active Reading: Examining a Text

When studying a text closely, consider the following points. Note that reading exam questions often test your ability to understand these elements of a text:

1. What is the text about / the main idea?

Look at the title, sub-title and any pictures, graphs or tables

Read the introduction. Look for a thesis statement (a sentence showing what the article is about). Note that in some academic texts this could be in the second paragraph.

Skim the paragraphs. What are most paragraphs about? The balance of information often reflects the main purpose of the article.

Read the conclusion. It should reaffirm your thoughts on the main idea of the article.

Note that in test conditions, some students prefer to answer these types of questions last after reading the text in more detail from answering the other questions.

2. What type of text is it?

Is the writer just reporting the facts of news, an event or research; or are they describing the causes and / or effects of something; or are they providing a comparison or giving an opinion?

Where would you see this type of text? The topic, length and use of vocabulary should indicate if it is an article aimed at the average reader (e.g. a newspaper article) or the more academic reader (e.g. a science journal).

What tense is used? Does it change? Why?

3. What is the main idea of each paragraph?

It's important, especially in test situations, to understand the main idea of each paragraph. Look for the topic sentence (usually first or second).

The main idea should be supported with an explanation and / or examples.

4. Does the writer include facts (statistics, dates, people)?

If so, what do these statistics mean? It's important to understand them. If graphs or tables are provided with a text, it's vital to read and understand them.

If dates are given, why? They often indicate something important.

If people are mentioned, why? Are they experts, witnesses or giving opinion? Again, it's important to consider why individuals or organizations are mentioned in a text and what role they play.

5. Does the writer suggest or imply anything?

Sometimes a writer suggests something (e.g. an opinion) without saying it directly. Can you see any examples in the text?

6. Is there any unknown vocabulary?

Again, underline any unknown/unsure vocabulary. Read the sentences before and after the word. Does any information help to guess the meaning of the word?

Key:
Main idea
Useful information
Vocab
Reference

Text 3: Seawater greenhouses to bring life to the desert

Fig 1. The Sahara Forest Project: the most recent attempt to **'green'** the de-

This paragraph interduce the idea of a project that want to make the desert a proper place to plant.

(A) The world is not short of water; it is just in the wrong places and too salty. Converting seawater to fresh water, in the right places, offers great potential for agriculture. Vast greenhouses that use seawater to grow crops could be combined with solar power plants to provide food, fresh water and clean energy in deserts, under an ambitious proposal from a team of architects and engineers. The project aims to overcome the region's inhospitable conditions to help farmers drastically increase their crop yields, providing them with a consistent, sustainable income. A worthwhile aim, **but the scheme is even more ambitious than it first appears.**

greenhouses + solar power plant = food+ fresh water +clean energy

hard and difficult to live in.

plan or arrangement

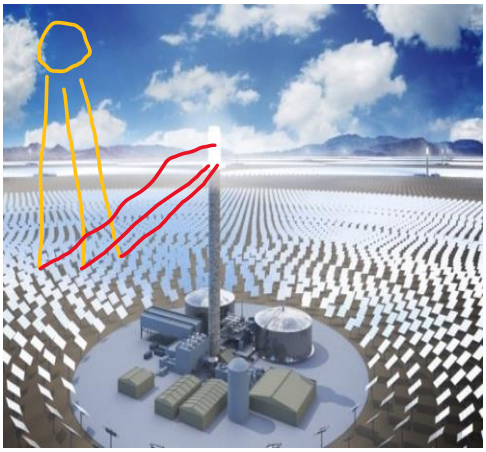

Fig. 2The Sahara Forest Project will use seawater and concentrated solar power to grow food in greenhouses across the desert

(B) The Sahara Forest Project would marry huge greenhouses with concentrated solar power (CSP), which uses mirrors to focus the sun's rays and generate heat and electricity. These hybrid installations would, according to their designers, turn deserts into lush patches of vegetation, without the need to dig wells for fresh water, which has depleted aquifers in many parts of the world.

use up the supply or resources.

(C) Plants cannot grow in deserts because of the extreme temperatures and lack of nutrients and water. Plants need light for growth but they don't like heat beyond a certain point. Above a particular temperature, the amount of water lost through the holes in their leaves, called stomata, gets so large that a plant will shut down photosynthesis and cannot grow.

Refers to the plants.

the process by which plant use sunlight to get foods.

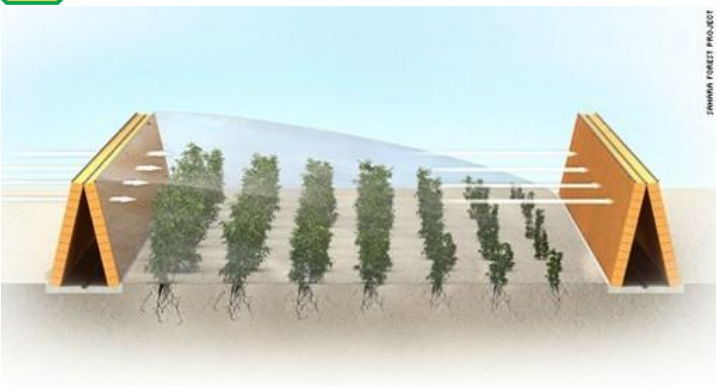

Fig. 3 Releasing humid air produced by the greenhouses produces an environment that permits the growth of some tough plant species.

(D) The greenhouses work by using the solar farm to power seawater evaporators, which cool the air and then pump the damp, cool air through the greenhouse. This reduces the temperature by about 15°C compared to the external ambient temperature and increases humidity. This reduction produces optimum temperatures for plant growth.

Refers to the act of cooling the air and pump it into the greenhouses.

perfect

(E) The Sahara Forest Project will use water from the Red Sea to produce fresh water for the crops and to grow algae in open ponds for fuel and food. Because each 10,000 square meters of seawater greenhouse evaporates 50 tons of water daily, the greenhouse will help restore vegetation on the surrounding arid land through releasing the excess humidity to create a cooler and more humid microclimate downwind of the greenhouse. The **"lost"** humidity will also increase the chance of rainfall in the area.

(F) This 'artificial' environment created by the greenhouse opens up the possibility for commercial cultivation of halophytes, plants that can survive or even thrive in salty growing conditions. These plants can be grown as animal fodder or as energy crops for biofuel production. They also serve as soil stabilizers, preventing sandstorms and soil erosion.

how?

Refers to the halophytes.

(G) Is it possible these seawater greenhouses are really the 'ultimate green solution'? Using a renewable energy source, they produce food, energy and drinking water while at the same time converting barren, arid desert into biologically productive land. The potential of these desert technologies is huge. Concentrated solar power mirror arrays covering just 1% of the Earth's deserts could supply a fifth of all current global energy consumption. And one million tonnes of sea water could be evaporated every day from just 20, 000 hectares of greenhouses. It seems so easy. It seems so simple. It almost seems too good to be true.

These numbers show us how we can use sea water to produce more energy in less spaces.

In the midterm and final exam reading, the questions are multi-choice. The questions you will be asked are similar to the ones below.

1. The purpose of paragraph (A) is to…
a. support desalinization technology.
b. illustrate the problems associated with desert agriculture.
c. highlight the problem of water distribution.
d. introduce the Sahara project.

2. Which of the following gives the main idea of paragraph(A)?
a. Scientists aim to use seawater and solar power to produce drinking water for farmers.
b. improve the lives of people living in desert regions.
c. develop new varieties of crops for desert regions.
d. test a new greenhouse technology.

3. The author writes "but the scheme is even more ambitious than it first appears because …
a. the scheme aims to transform the desert.
b. previous attempts to improve desert agriculture have failed.
c. the technology is to be used all over the world.
d. if successful, the economic benefits could be huge.

4. In paragraph (B) 'marry' means almost the same as …
a. combine.
b. build.
c. design.
d. replace.

5. Paragraph (C) mainly explains …
a. why photosynthesis is important for plant growth.
b. the relationship between temperature and water loss in deserts.
c. the difficulty the desert environment creates for plant growth.
d. the need to control temperatures in deserts.

6. In paragraph C 'stomata' means …
a. drops
b. leaves
c. holes
d. degrees

7. Photosynthesis stops because …

a. of temperature fluctuations.
b. the stomata get too big.
c. of too much sunlight.
d. of excessive water loss.

8. Paragraph (D) mainly describes …

a. how the greenhouses achieve the best conditions for plant growth.
b. the characteristics of deserts which make them unsuitable for plants.
c. how the greenhouses use seawater evaporators.
d. how the latest technology is used in the greenhouses.

9. The word "lost" in paragraph E appears in quotation marks because …

a. the water returns to the sea.
b. it is a short quotation.
c. the water is deliberately released.
d. the water escapes from the greenhouse.

10. Which of the following is NOT a consequence of the "lost" humidity?

a. Rainfall may increase.
b. Seawater consumption will rise.
c. Temperatures will fall.
d. Humidity will increase.

11. Halophytes are plants that …

a. live in desert environments.
b. tolerate high temperatures.
c. live in salty environments.
d. prevent sandstorms.

12. In paragraph (F) 'thrive' means …

a. live
b. die
c. do well
d. grow

13. The main objective of the Sahara Forest project is …

a. to improve lives and transform the desert.
b. to reduce dependence on local water resources.
c. to create economic development.
d. to irrigate the desert using seawater.

14. The author finishes the text with, *"It almost seems too good to be true."* **Why? What can we infer from this statement?**

The author ends the text with this sentence to show that this project is possible to be established and it can help developing the deserts. Moreover, with the development of technology everything is developing, the cities, the houses, and even the desert can be a better place.

15. Choose one: Do you think a similar project would work in KSA? Explain your answer. OR

Do you know of any comparable projects in KSA using the same or similar technology?

Saudi Arabia have a lot of deserts and they make up third of its land. Exploiting this huge area to plant would be a smart decision as Saudi Arabia 2030 vision is aiming to make the country green. Also, building greenhouse will increase the types of plants the country grows and enable the farmers to plant different species. Moreover, Saudi is depending on oil and petrol now but in the future it will need to use more proper methods to get energy such as solar and wind power. A project such as Sahara Forest Project would be a smart investment in Saudi Arabia.

Text 4 Pre-Reading Activities

The title of the reading is:

You and Your Data

(Mandatory)

1.Based on the title, what do you think the text is about?

I think it will be something related to technology, and by the data the author perhaps means the information in our phones.

2. Based on the title, what type of text do you think this is?

From the title I think it is a text that will talk about our data and how we are using them and maybe it will provide some recommendation of how to secure our data.

3. Based on the title, what sort of specific information do you think you are going to read about?

How the devices we use control our data?
Is it safe to put our all information in our phones?

Vocabulary Preview:

Based on your prior knowledge, can you define any of the following words?

digital	Related to technology.
compromising	Uncomfortable.
accessible	Easy to reach.
demanding	Hard-require a lot of things.
consent	Agreement.

Key:
Main idea
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Vocab
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The purpose of paragraph A is to introduce the function of how our devices collect our data and it give a real example to make the reader aware of what is happening inside their phone if the search for anything.

READING #4

You and Your Data

A. As the internet and digital technology become a bigger part of our lives, more of our data becomes publicly accessible, leading to questions about privacy. So, how do we interact with the growing digital world without compromising the security of our information and our right to privacy? Imagine that you want to learn a new language. You search 'Is German a difficult language?' on your phone. You click on a link and read an article with advice for learning German. There's a search function to find German courses, so you enter your city name. It asks you to activate location services to find courses near you. You click 'accept'. You then message a German friend to ask for her advice. When you look her up on social media, an advertisement for a book and an app called German for Beginners instantly pops up. Later the same day, while you're sending an email, you see an advert offering you a discount at a local language school. How did they know? The simple answer is online data. At all stages of your search, your devices, websites and applications were collecting data on your preferences and tracking your behavior online. 'They' have been following you.

All of these does not take you a minute to do it. However, it gives the device the data it wants to make you attracted.

B. Who uses our data and why?

We can understand from this paragraph that in the past our information was more secure than now.

In the past, it was easy for people to keep track of their personal information. Like their possessions, people's information existed mostly in physical form: on paper, kept in a folder, locked in a cupboard or an office. Today, our personal information can be collected and stored online, and it is accessible to more people than ever before. Many of us share our physical location, our travel plans, our political opinions, our shopping interests and our family photos online – as key services like ordering a takeaway meal, booking a plane, taking part in a poll or buying new clothes now take place online and require us to give out our data.

Every search you make, service you use, message you send and item you buy is part of your 'digital footprint'. Companies and online platforms use this 'footprint' to track exactly what we are doing, from what links we click on to how much time we spend on a website. Based on your online activity, they can guess what you are interested in and what things you might want to buy. Knowing so much about you gives online platforms and companies a lot of power and a lot of money. By selling your data or providing targeted content, companies can turn your online activity into profit. This is the foundation of the growing industry of digital marketing.

That is why they know how to attract you by sending adverts for the things you search for.

Most people are not aware of how simple thing they do in internet can be tracked and be used by other people.

C. Can you protect your data? Yes … and no!

Some of the time our personal data is shared online with our consent. We post our birthday, our photographs and even our opinions online on social media. We know that this information is publicly accessible. However, our data often travels further than we realize, and can be used in ways that we did not intend.

an act of breaking or failing to observe a law.

an action or event regarded as morally or legally wrong.

Certain news scandals about data breaches, where personal data has been lost, leaked, or shared without consent, have recently made people much more aware of the potential dangers of sharing information online. So, can we do anything to protect our data? Or should we just accept that in fact nothing is 'free' and sharing our data is the price we have to pay for using many online services? As people are increasingly aware of and worried about data protection, governments and organizations are taking a more active role in protecting privacy. For example, the European Union passed the General Data Protection Law, which regulates how personal information is collected online. However, there is still much work to be done.

That means the government is not completely responsible to safe our data. We should be more aware of the data we entered on the internet.

D. As internet users, we should all have a say in how our data is used. It is important that we pay more attention to how data is acquired, where it is stored and how it is used. As the ways in which we use the internet continue to grow and change, we will need to stay informed and keep demanding new laws and regulations, and better information about how to protect ourselves. Safer Internet Day is an ideal time to find out more about this topic.

The users are responsible to protect their data and keep track with the changes on the internet every moment.

Active Reading – Examining the Text (You and Your Data)

(Mandatory)

1. What is the author's purpose in writing this text?

The author wants to illustrate the process our data go on when we put them on the internet, and how it can take an unexpected way. The text also focusses on the importance of saving our data and how we should think about everything we accept in the internet.

2. In paragraph A, the author asks us to imagine we want to learn a foreign language. Why?

The author gives an example of the things people may search about on the internet and learning a foreign language is a simple example of how your data can be collected. Also, a lot of people see adverts and wonder of how that adverts find the way to come to them at the best time.

ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS IN PROPER PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

3. Do you have a 'digital footprint'? Explain your answer.

In my opinion there is no one who does not use internet these days, so everyone has a digital footprint, but it is difference from one person to another. For me, I do not share my personal photos or information because I think it is my privacy. However, some websites ask for some information as your name and location, I try to avoid these unreliable websites as much as I can, and I do not enter my personal information before I make sure this website is secure. I think that I am aware of the data I put on the internet, but you cannot make sure that you are 100% secure and your data is not used against you.

4. Based on the text and your own experience, who do you think is responsible for protecting your data: you, internet providers or companies/organizations. Explain your answer.

In my opinion, I think that the user is the responsible to make sure about saving the data. Sometimes you need to provide some information to the website, such as your country name or your age, to get the best service. The internet users should be aware of that and make sure that the website they are using is safety. Moreover, the internet providers company should give the users instruction of how to protect their data. In the end, the internet is a very wide world, and we have to keep track with the changes to make sure that we using it in a proper way that is useful to use and secure to our data.